User Guide

HEALTH AI Co-Creation & Innovation Platform

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Course	SENG 384 – Software Engineering Design
Group No / Name	SoloStack
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(Right-click and select “Update Field” in Word to refresh)

1. Introduction

1.1 Document Purpose

This User Guide provides step-by-step instructions for all user roles (Engineer, Healthcare Professional, and Admin) to effectively use the HEALTH AI Co-Creation & Innovation Platform. It covers account registration and login, post creation and management, partner discovery, meeting request workflows, profile management, and the admin panel. It is intended to be the primary reference for any user interacting with the platform.

1.2 Target Audience

User Role	Description	Relevant Sections
Engineer	Creates posts, searches for healthcare partners	Sections 2–6, 8
Healthcare Professional	Browses posts, sends meeting requests	Sections 2–6, 8
Admin	Manages users, posts, and views system logs	Sections 2, 7

1.3 Platform Overview

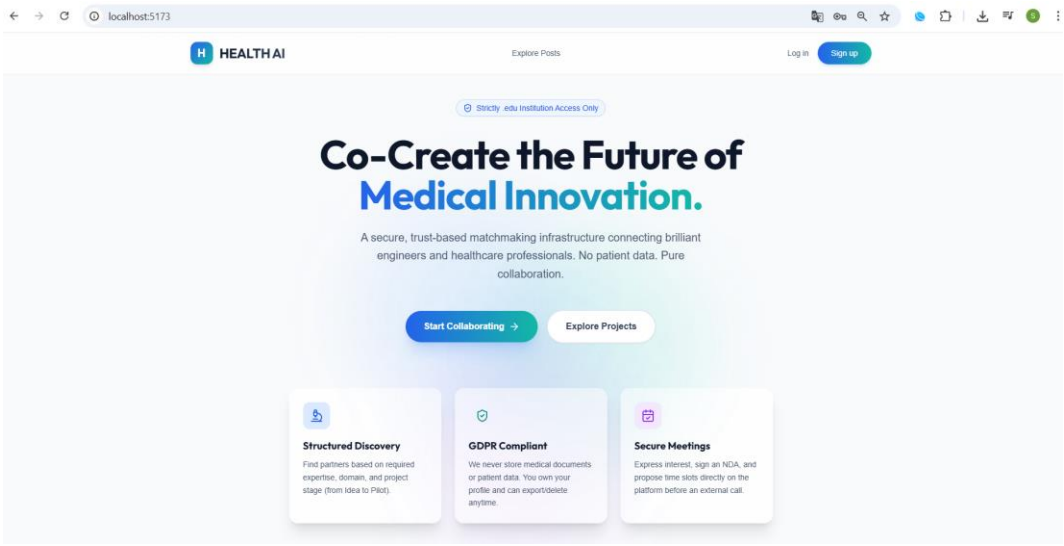
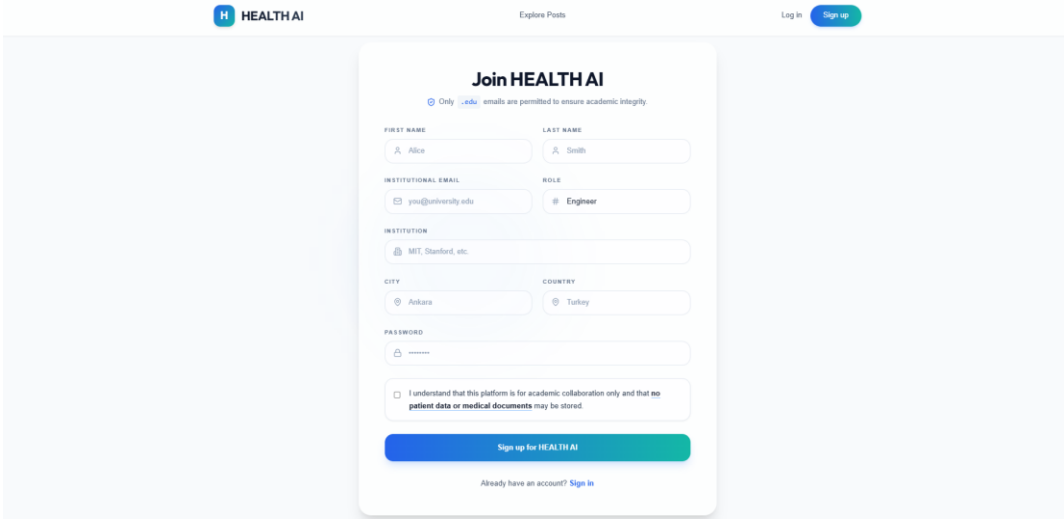
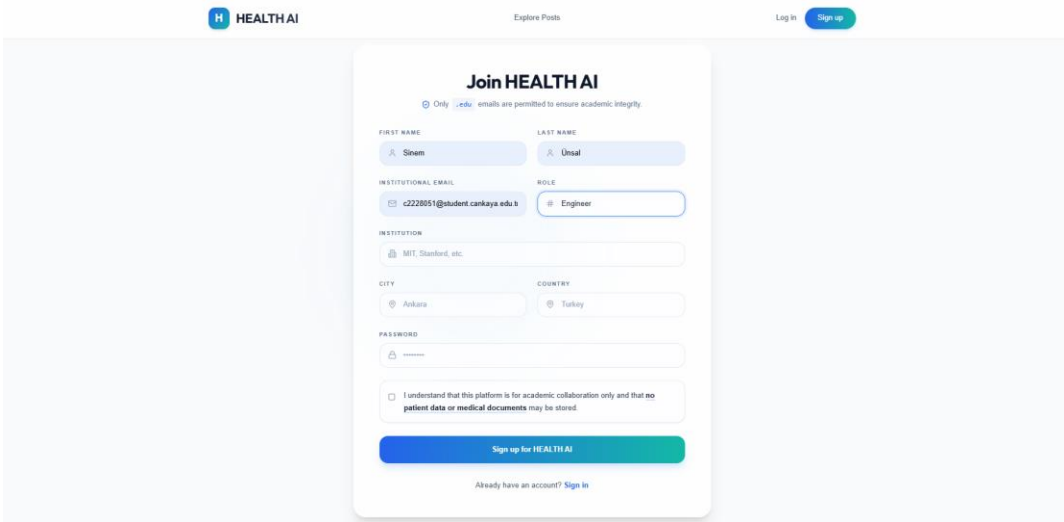
HEALTH AI is a web-based co-creation and innovation platform designed to connect healthcare professionals and engineers for structured collaboration. Engineers publish collaboration posts describing their project ideas, required expertise, and project stage, while healthcare professionals browse and express interest in these opportunities. When two parties connect, the platform facilitates a structured meeting request workflow — including NDA acceptance and time-slot negotiation — so that the first contact is both secure and organised. All interactions are governed by role-based access control, activity logging, and GDPR-compliant data management.

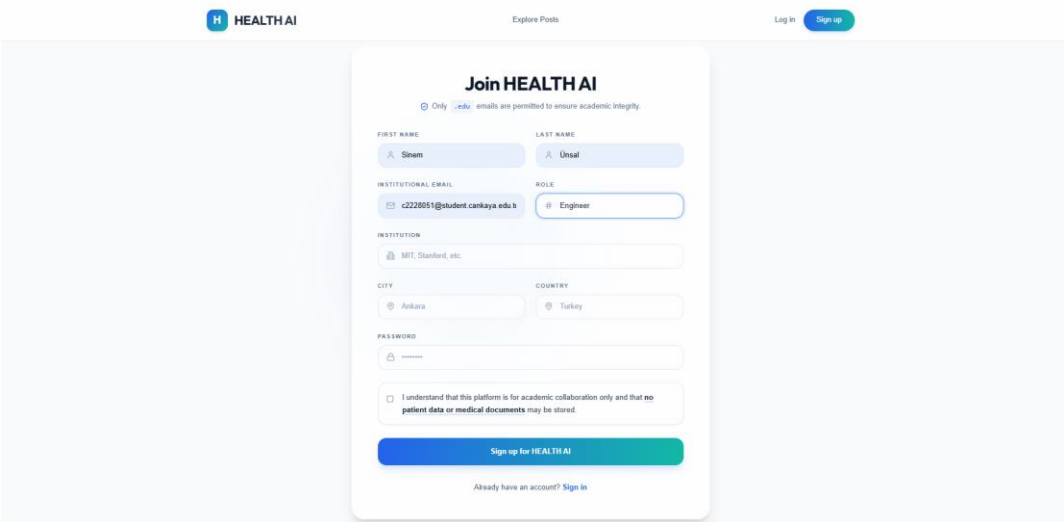
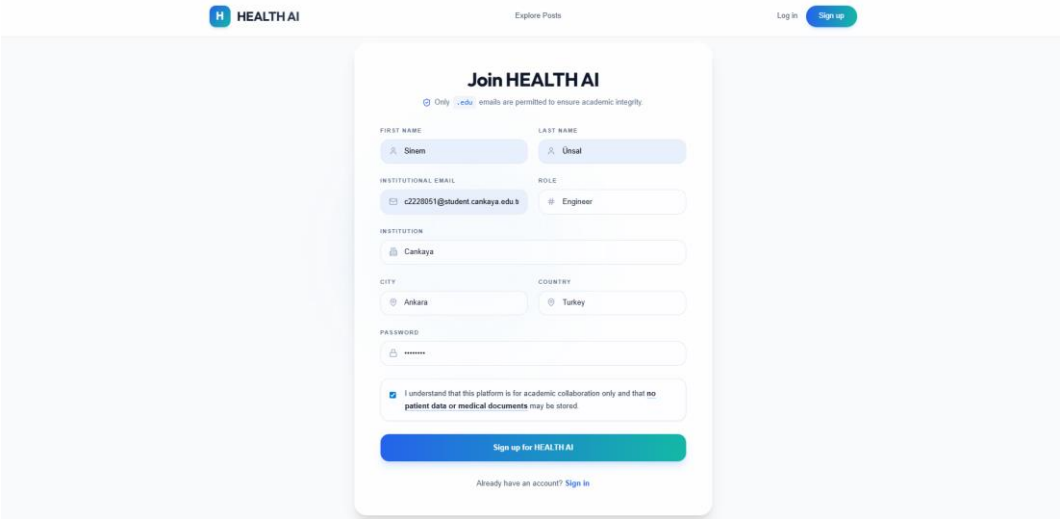
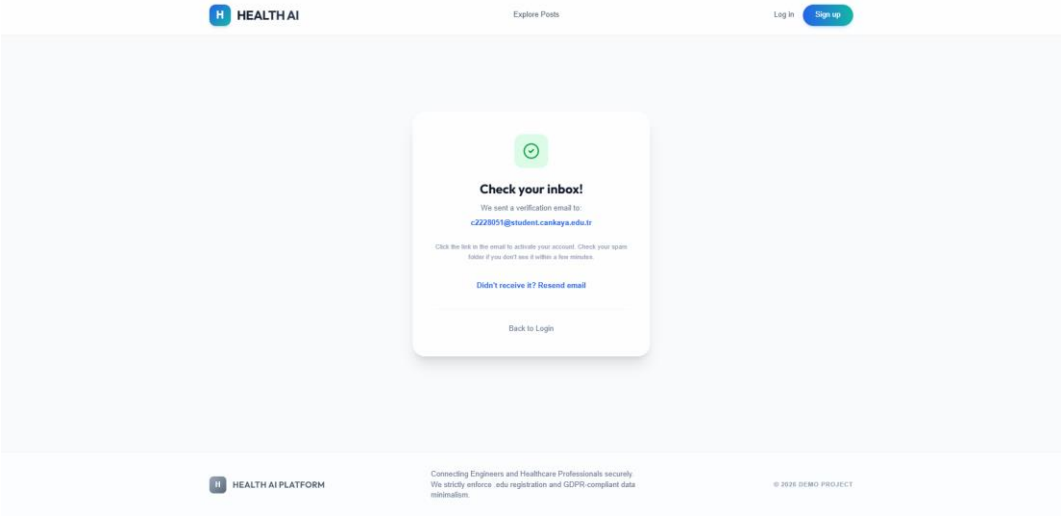
1.4 System Requirements

Requirement	Details
Web Browser	Google Chrome (latest), Firefox (latest), Edge (latest), Safari (latest)
Internet Connection	Stable broadband connection required
Screen Resolution	Minimum 1280×720, recommended 1920×1080
Email	A valid institutional .edu email address is required for registration

2. Getting Started

2.1 Registration

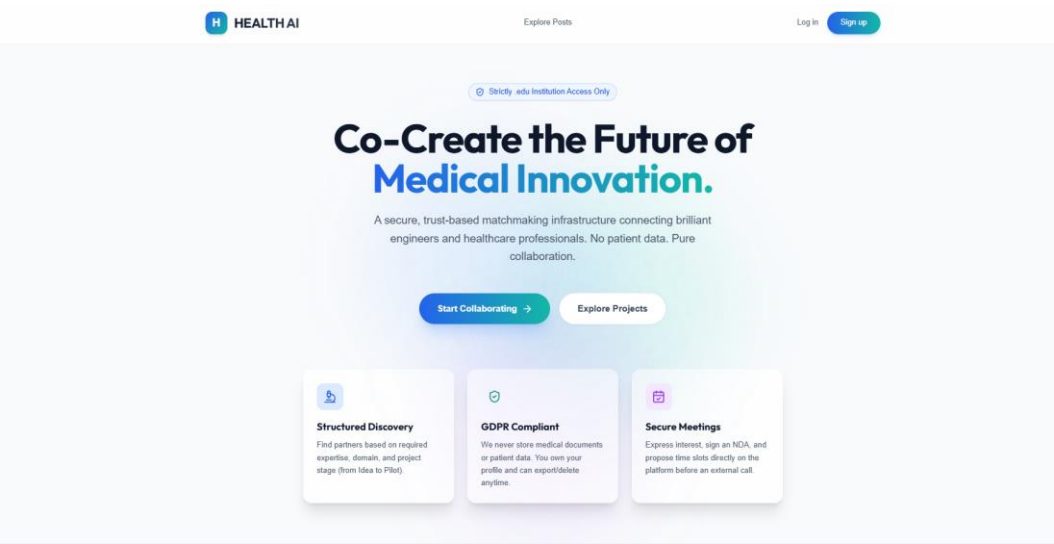
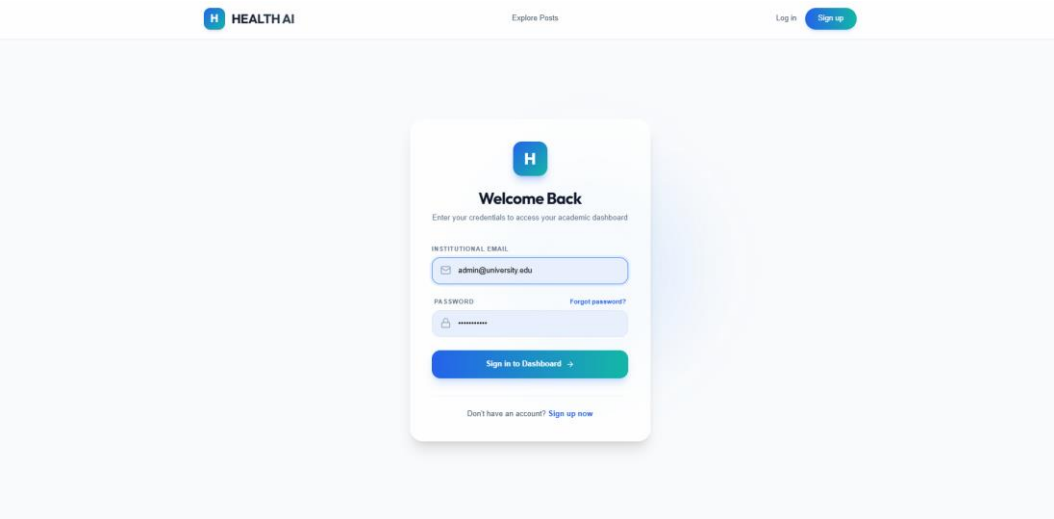
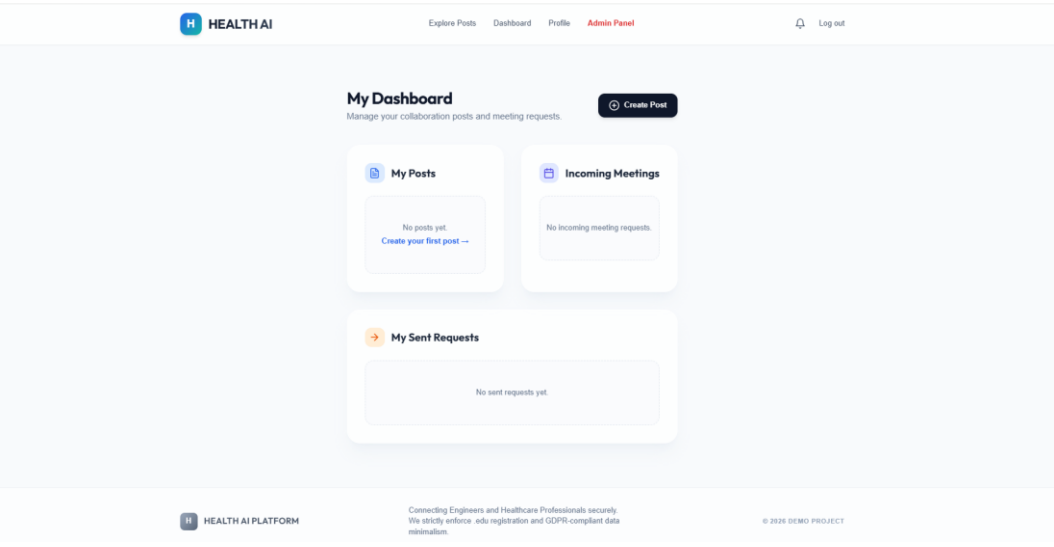
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to the HEALTH AI platform URL in your web browser.	
2	Click the “Register” button on the homepage.	
3	Enter your institutional .edu email address, choose a strong password, and fill in your First Name, Last Name, Institution, City, and Country.	

4	Select your role: Engineer or Healthcare Professional.	
5	Click “Register”. A verification email will be sent to your address.	
6	Open the verification email and click the confirmation link.	

✉ Email Verification Required

After clicking “Register” you will receive a verification email at your .edu address. Click the link in the email to activate your account before logging in. If the email does not arrive within a few minutes: (1) check your spam/junk folder, (2) on the login page enter your credentials — if unverified, a banner will appear with a “Resend verification email” button. The link expires in 24 hours.

2.2 Login

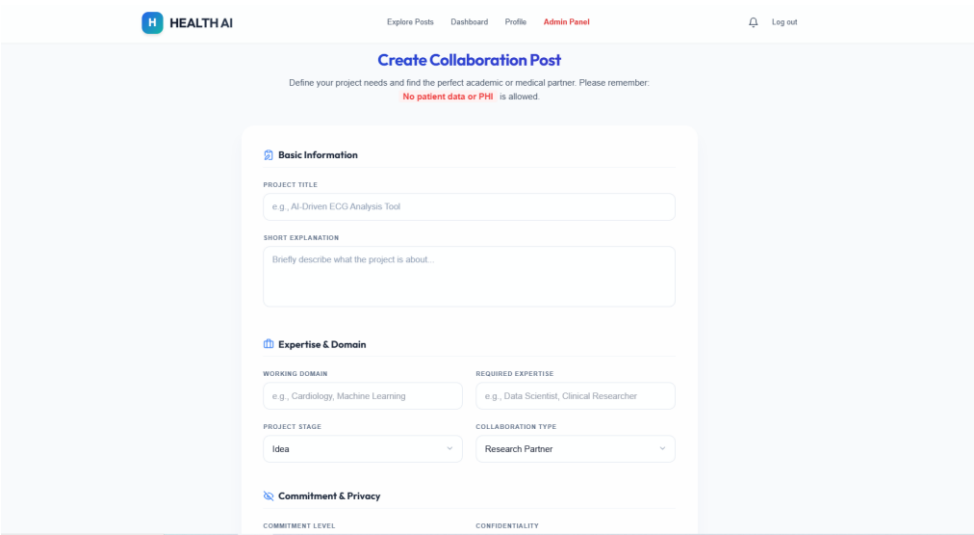
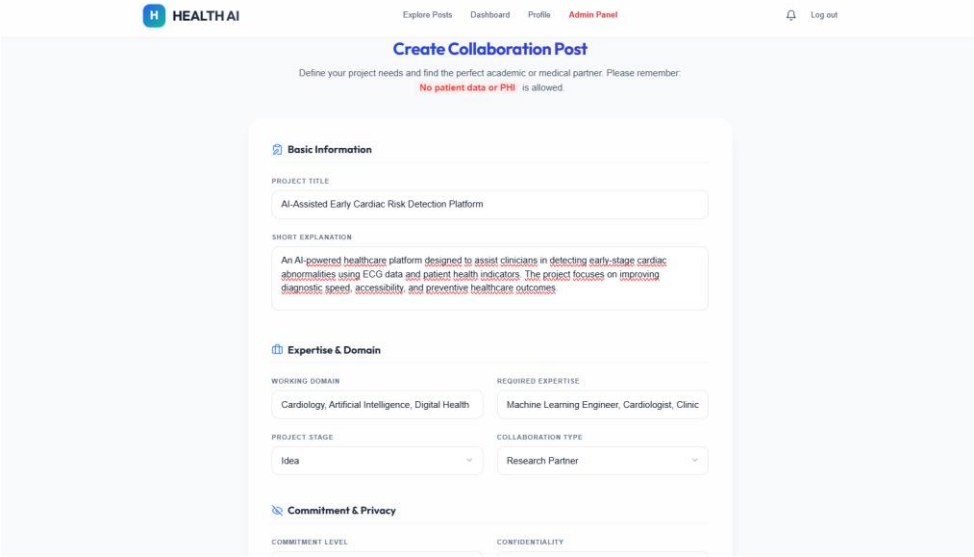
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to the HEALTH AI platform URL.	
2	Enter your email address and password.	
3	Click “Login”. You will be redirected to your Dashboard.	

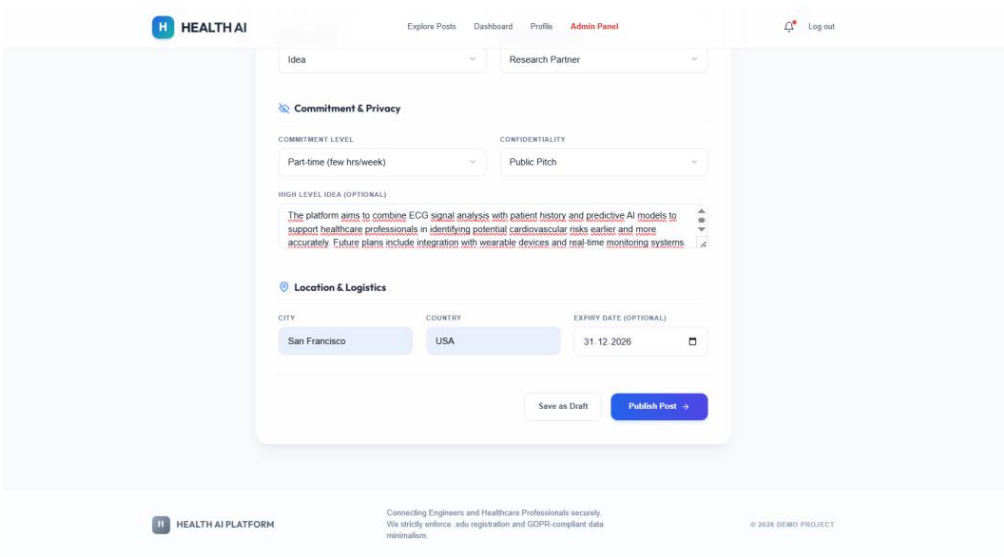
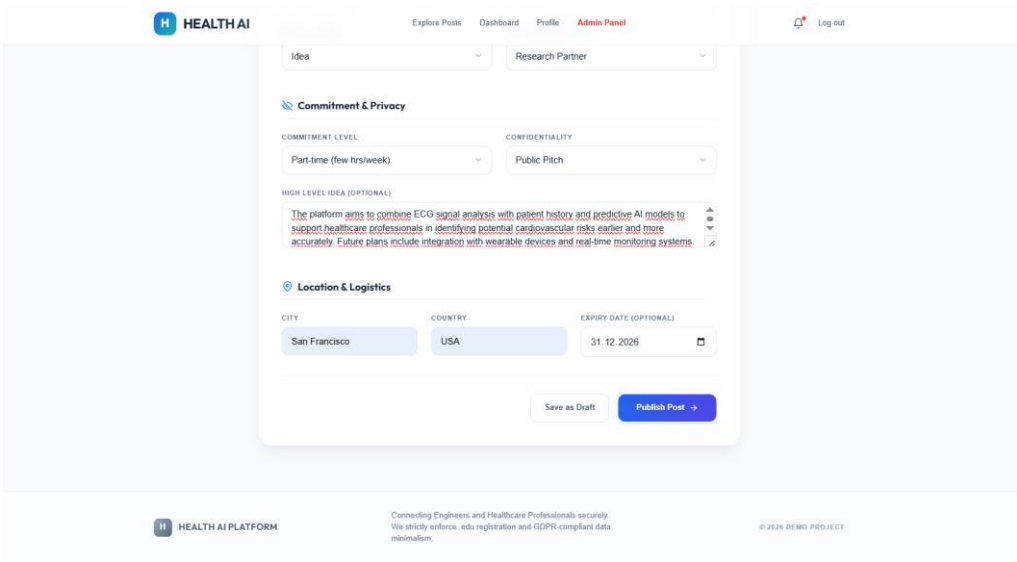
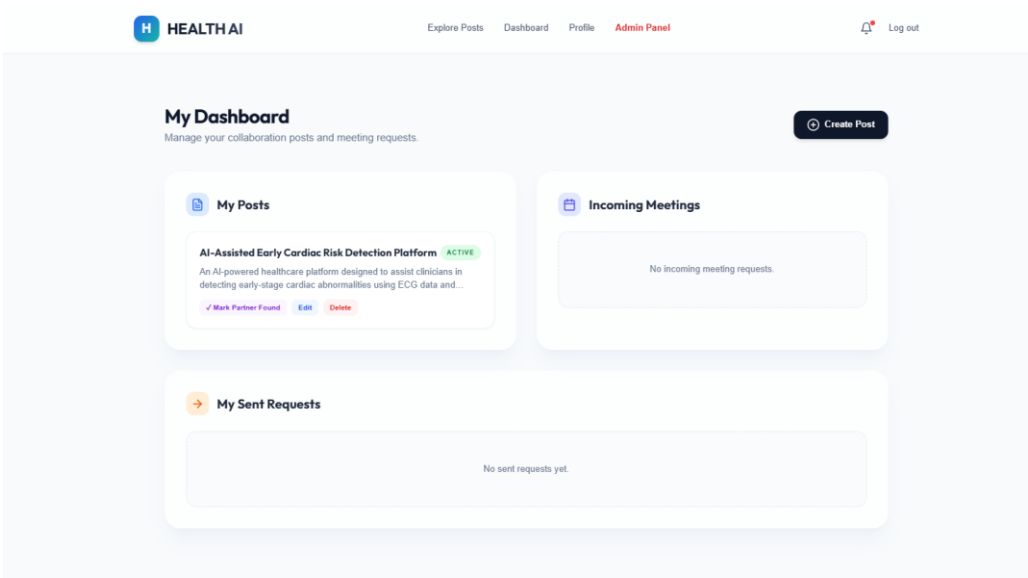
2.3 Dashboard Overview

After a successful login, you are directed to the Dashboard. The top navigation bar displays the platform logo on the left, a search bar for finding posts, a bell icon that shows your unread notification count, and a profile avatar that links to your account settings. The main area shows the collaboration post feed, which lists all Active posts in reverse-chronological order. Each post card displays the title, domain, required expertise, project stage, city, and a match explanation if your location overlaps. Engineers also see a "New Post" button to create a collaboration opportunity. Use the filters on the search/results page to narrow the feed by domain, city, expertise, or project stage.

3. Post Management

3.1 Creating a New Post

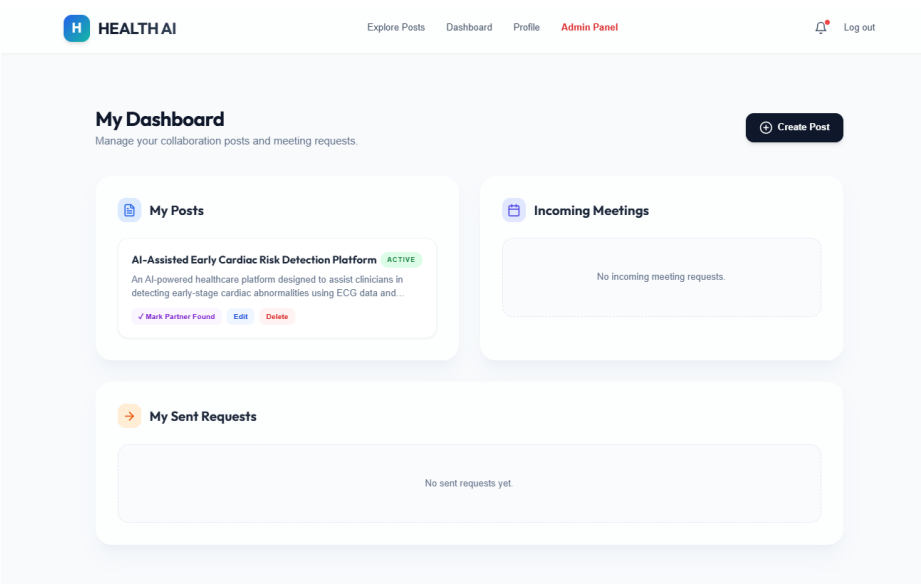
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Click the "New Post" button on the Dashboard.	
2	Fill in all required fields in the post creation form (see field guide below).	

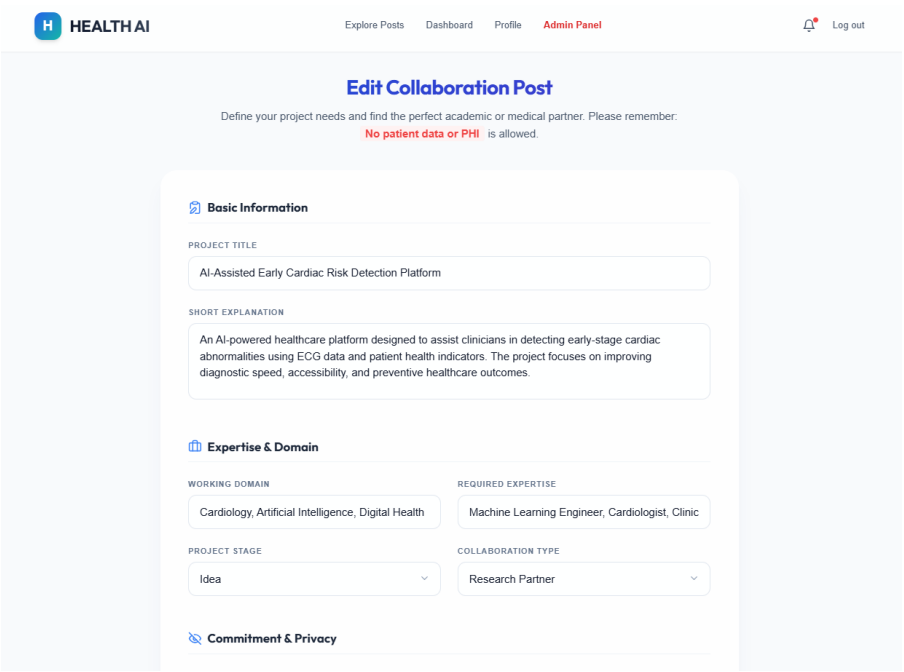
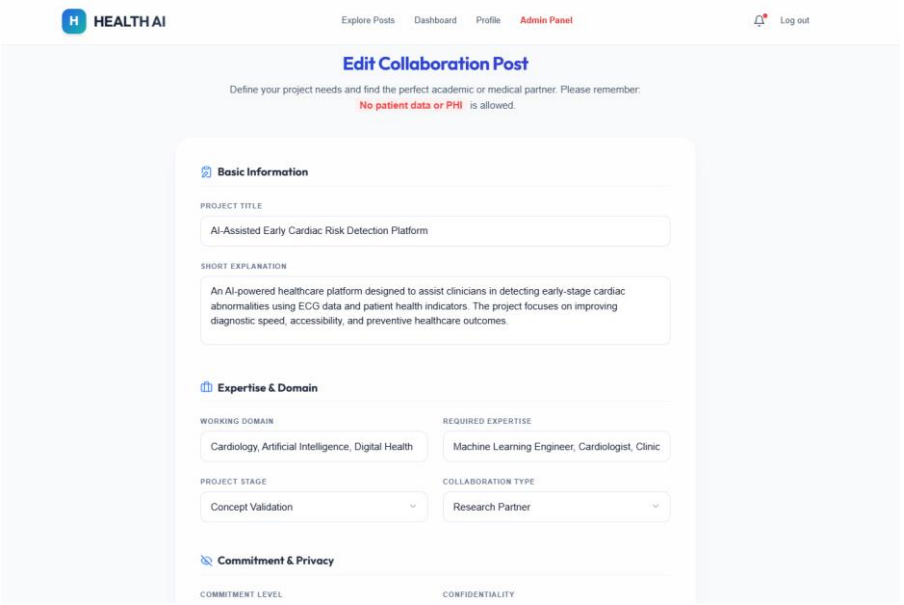
3	Choose whether to save as Draft or Publish immediately.	
4	Click “Save” or “Publish”.	
5	Your post will appear on the Dashboard with the appropriate status.	

3.2 Post Form Fields

Field	Description	Example
Title	A clear and descriptive title for your collaboration post	"AI-Assisted Cardiology Diagnosis"
Working Domain	The medical or engineering domain of the project	Cardiology, Radiology, Orthopedics
Required Expertise	The type of expertise you are looking for in a partner	"Machine Learning Engineer"
Project Stage	Current stage of the project	Idea / Concept Validation / Prototype Developed / Pilot Testing / Pre-Deployment
Confidentiality Level	How sensitive is the project content?	Public / Confidential
City	Your location for city-based matching	Ankara, Istanbul, Izmir
Description	Detailed description of the collaboration opportunity	Enter a detailed description of your collaboration opportunity, goals, and expected outcomes.
Country	Country where the collaboration is based	Turkey, Germany, UK
Commitment Level	Expected time and effort commitment from the collaborating partner	Part-time / Full-time / Advisory

3.3 Editing a Post

Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to your post (from Dashboard or “My Posts”).	

2	Click the “Edit” button.	
3	Modify the desired fields and click “Save”.	

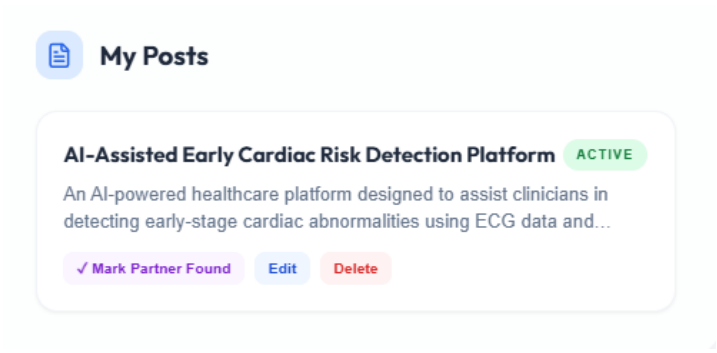
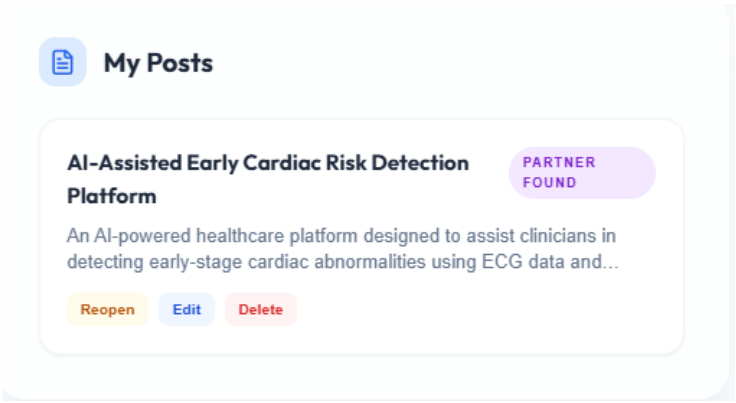
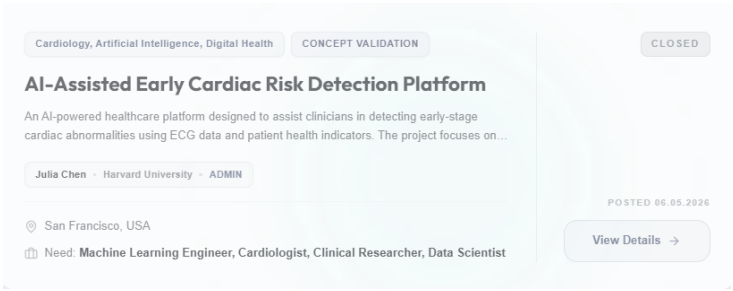
3.4 Post Status Guide

Each collaboration post moves through a defined lifecycle. The table below explains every possible status and its meaning.

Status	Meaning	Visual Indicator
Draft	Post is saved but not visible to other users	Grey badge in post card header
Active	Post is published and visible. Other users can express interest.	Green badge in post card header
Meeting Scheduled	A meeting has been scheduled with an interested partner	Blue badge in post card header

Partner Found	A collaboration partner has been found. Post is closed.	Purple badge in post card header
Expired	Post has expired due to inactivity or time limit	Red/Orange badge in post card header

3.5 Marking Partner Found

Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Open the post for which you found a partner.	
2	Click the “Mark as Partner Found” button.	
3	Confirm the action. The post status will change to “Partner Found” and will no longer accept new interest.	

4. Search & Partner Discovery

4.1 Browsing Posts

The Dashboard feed lists all Active collaboration posts. Each post card shows the title, working domain, required expertise, project stage, city, and the name of the posting institution. Click on any post card to open the Post Detail page, which shows the full description, high-level idea, collaboration type, commitment level, confidentiality level, and the owner’s profile summary. From the detail page you can express interest or send a meeting request if you are not the post owner.

4.2 Filtering Options

The Search & Results page provides server-side filters. Select one or more criteria and the results update automatically. All text filters use case-insensitive partial matching.

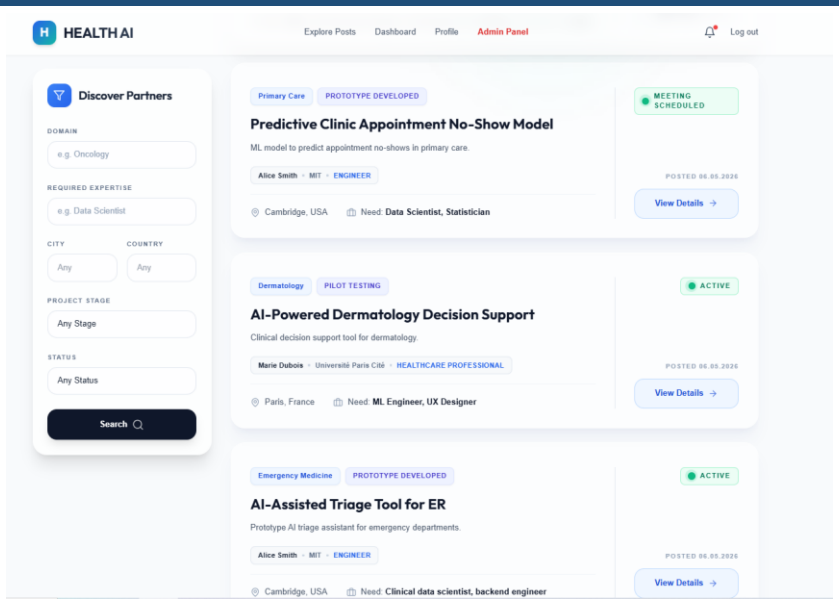
Filter	Description
Domain	Filter by medical or engineering domain (e.g., Cardiology, AI, Biomedical)
City	Filter by location for city-based matching
Status	Show only Active, Draft (own posts), or all statuses
Required Expertise	Filter by the type of expertise being sought
Country	Filter by country of the post owner (e.g., Turkey, Germany)

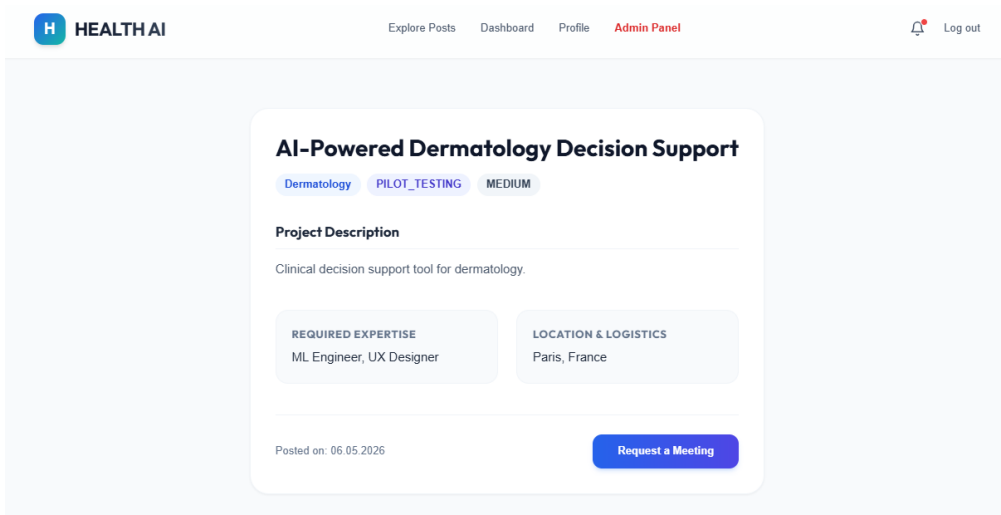
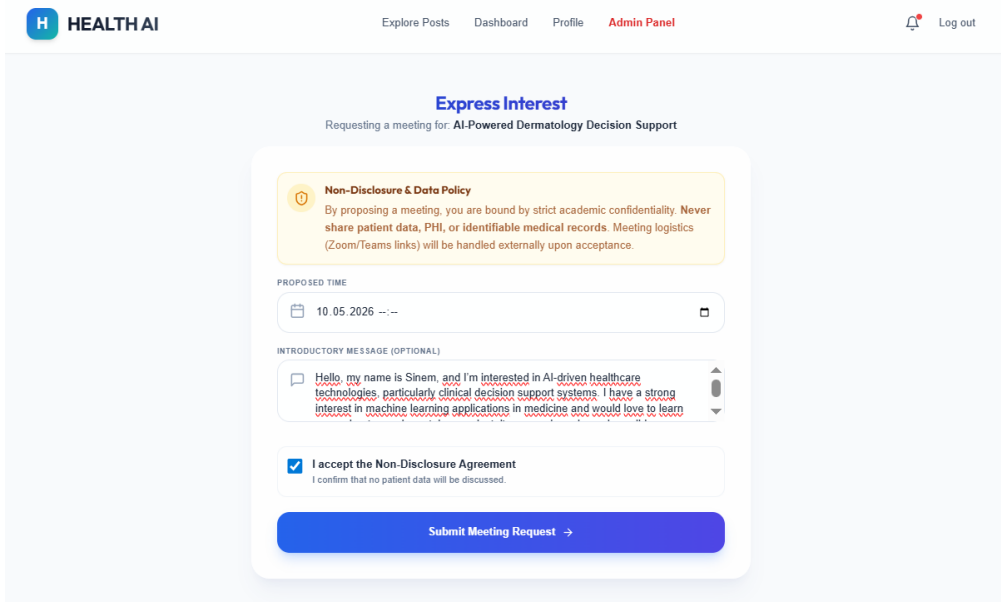
4.3 City-Based Matching

When you apply a City filter on the Search Results page, the backend compares the filter value against the city field stored on each post using a case-insensitive partial match. Posts where the city matches your filter appear at the top of the results and include a "Match Explanation" label (e.g., "Same city: Ankara") on the post card. This allows geographically co-located engineers and healthcare professionals to find each other easily and arrange in-person collaboration when needed.

5. Meeting Request Process

5.1 Expressing Interest

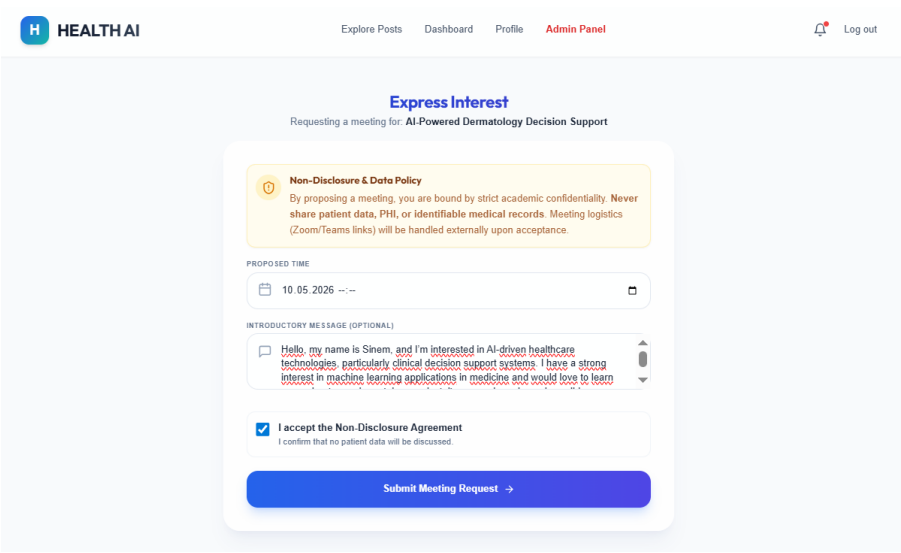
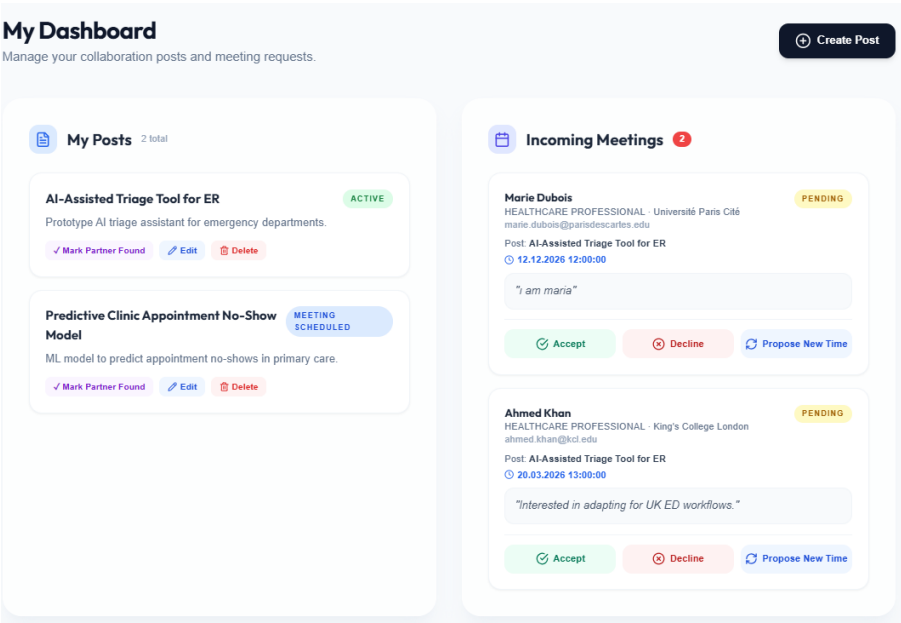
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Open the post detail page of a post you are interested in.	

2	Click the “Express Interest” or “Request Meeting” button.	
3	Optionally add a message explaining your interest and relevant experience.	

5.2 NDA Acceptance

Before a meeting request can be submitted, you must explicitly accept the platform’s Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA). A checkbox labelled “I accept the NDA terms” appears on the Meeting Request form. This checkbox must be ticked — leaving it unticked will cause the form submission to be rejected with the message “NDA must be accepted to request a meeting”. Your acceptance is recorded in the database alongside the meeting request, providing a verifiable audit trail. The NDA acceptance requirement applies to all meeting requests regardless of the post’s confidentiality level.

5.3 Proposing & Accepting Time Slots

Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Propose available time slots for the meeting (date and time).	
2	The post owner reviews proposed slots and accepts one.	
3	Both parties receive a confirmation notification with the scheduled meeting time.	

Note: Meetings take place externally (Zoom, Teams, etc.). The platform does not host meetings.

5.4 After the Meeting

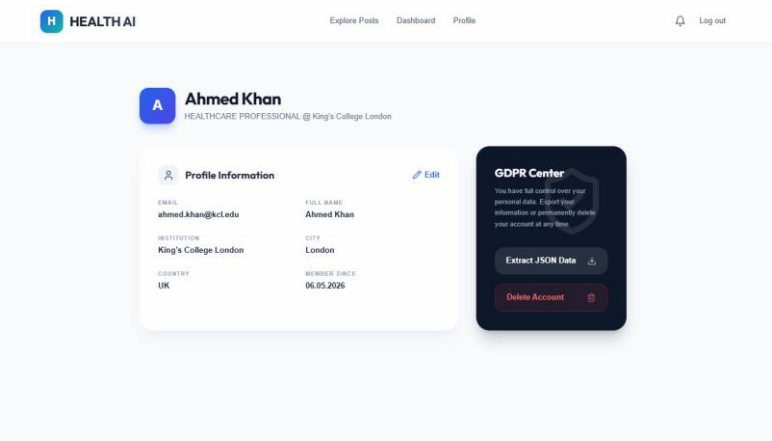
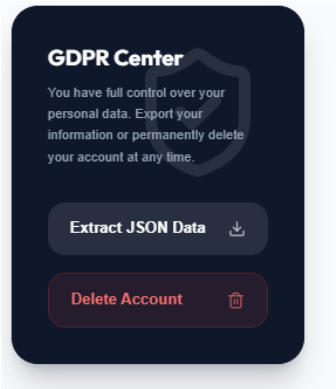
After the external meeting (held via Zoom, Microsoft Teams, or another platform of your choice), the post owner decides the next step. If a suitable collaboration partner has been identified, the owner opens the post and clicks "Mark as Partner Found", which changes the post status to PARTNER_FOUND and stops new interest expressions. If the owner wishes to continue searching, no action is required — the post remains in MEETING_SCHEDULED status until updated. Either party may also propose a new meeting time if further discussion is needed before committing to a partnership.

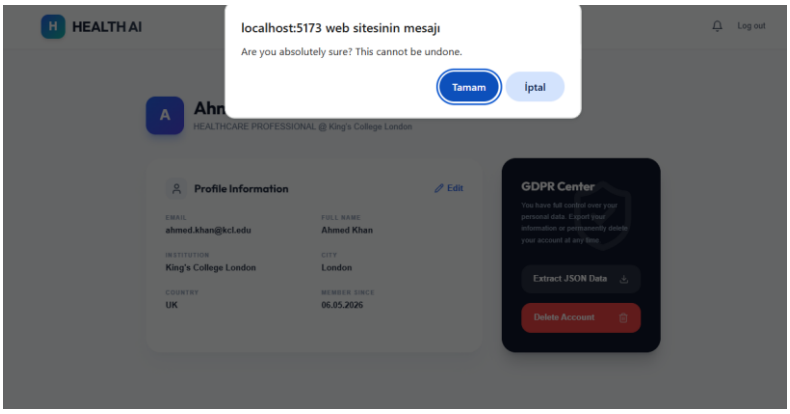
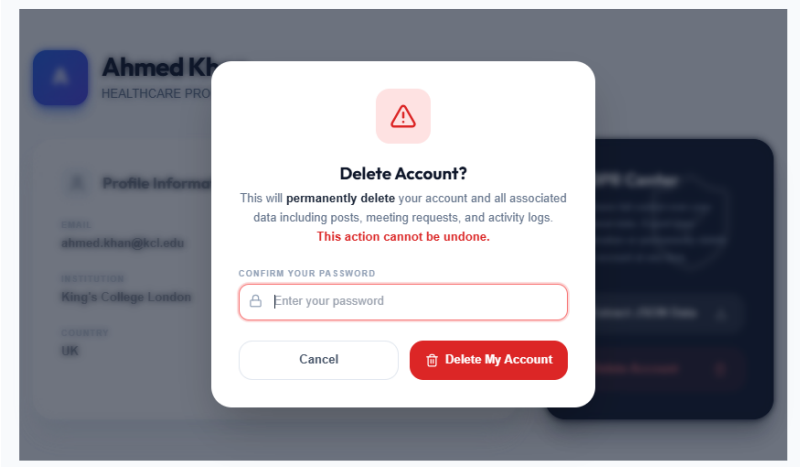
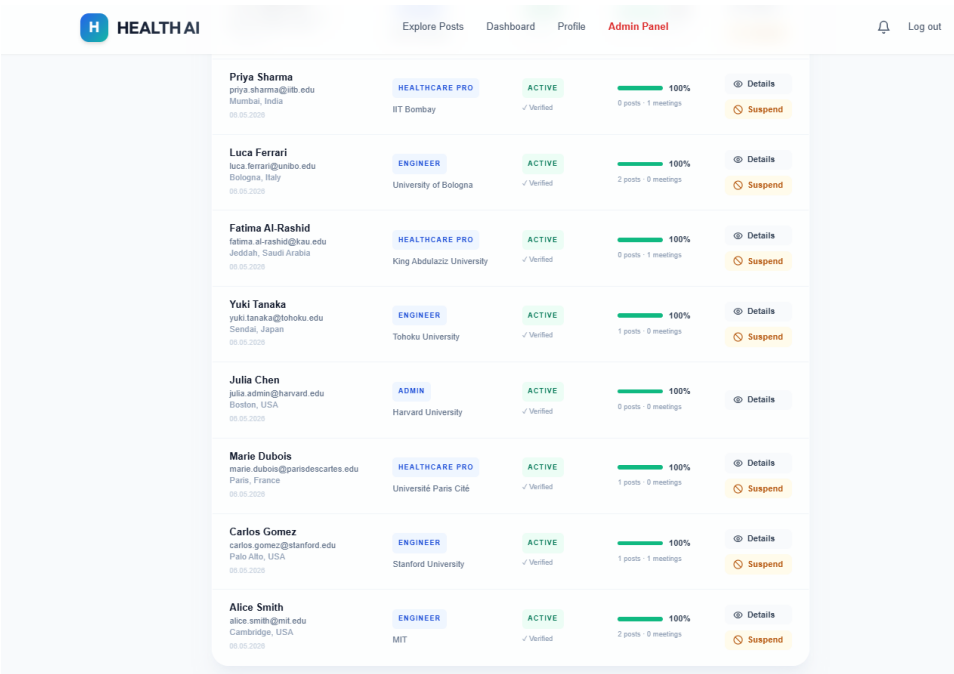
6. Profile Management

6.1 Editing Your Profile

Navigate to your profile by clicking your name or avatar in the top navigation bar. Your profile page shows your full name, institutional email, role, institution, city, and country. To update your information, click the "Edit Profile" button. You can modify your Full Name, Institution, City, and Country. Your email address and role cannot be changed after registration. Click "Save" to apply your changes. Profile completeness (shown in the Admin Panel) is calculated based on how many of these four fields you have filled in.

6.2 Deleting Your Account (GDPR)

Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to Profile Settings.	
2	Click "Delete Account".	

3	Read the warning about permanent data deletion.	
4	Confirm the deletion by clicking the “Confirm Delete” button in the confirmation dialog.	
5	Your account and all associated data will be permanently deleted.	

Under GDPR, users have the right to request complete deletion of their personal data.

6.3 Exporting Your Data

Under GDPR Article 20 (Right to Data Portability), you can download all data the platform holds about you. Navigate to Profile Settings and click “Export My Data”. The platform will generate a JSON file named my_data.json that includes your user profile, all posts you have created, all meeting requests you have sent (with related post details), and your full activity log. The download starts immediately in

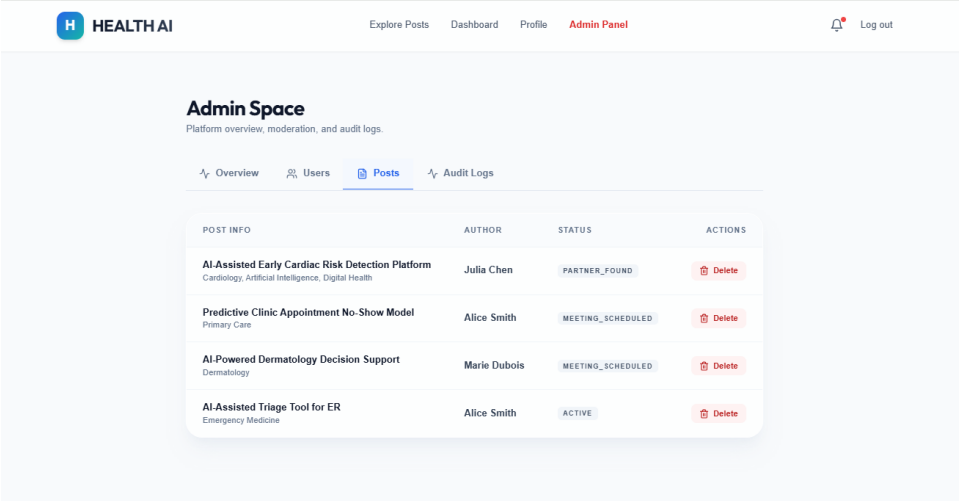
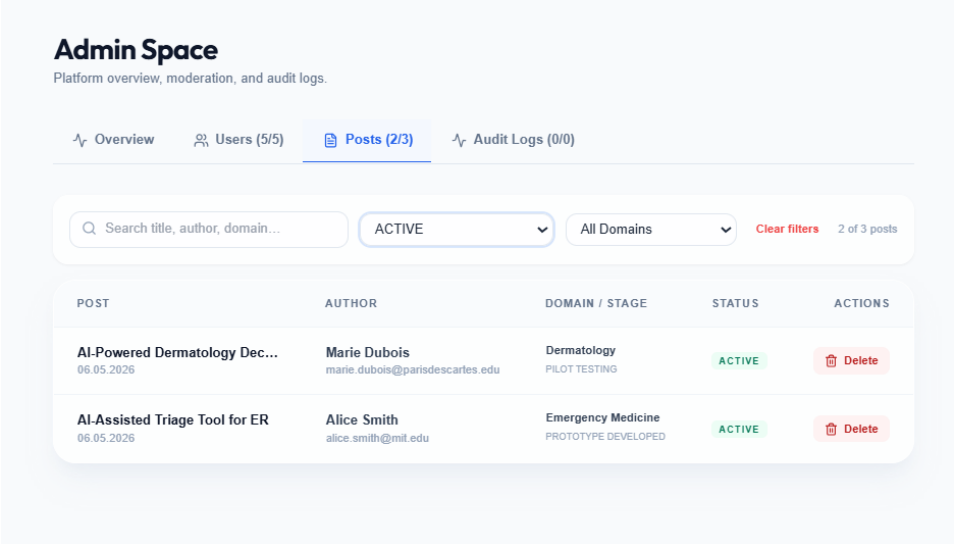
your browser. Store this file securely, as it contains personal and potentially confidential project information.

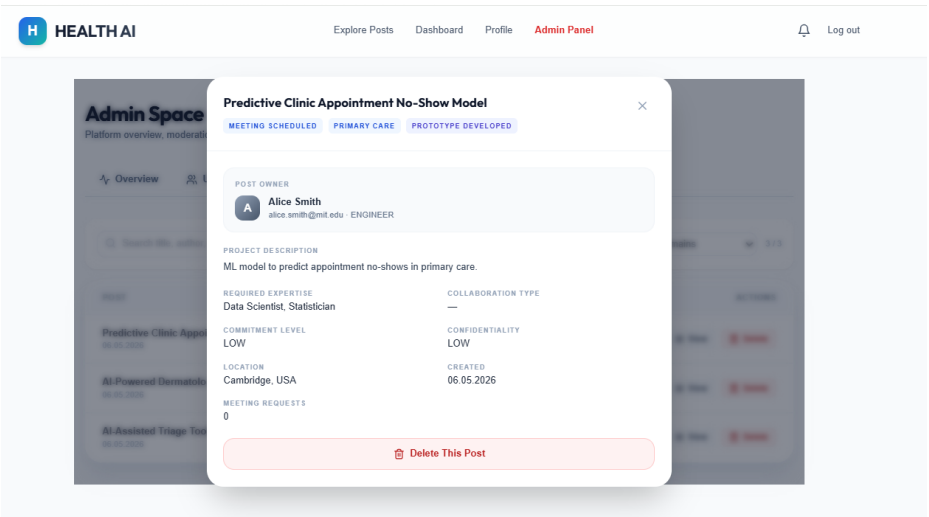
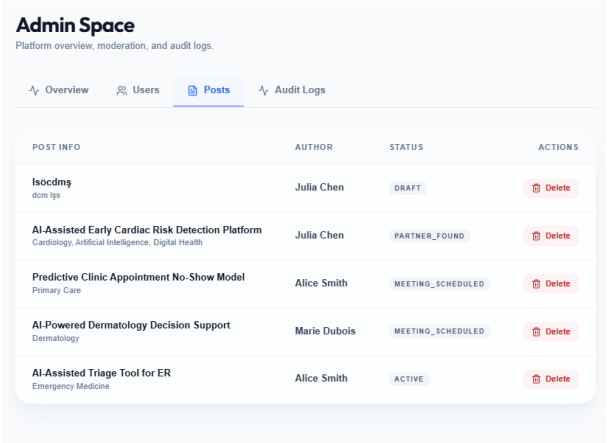
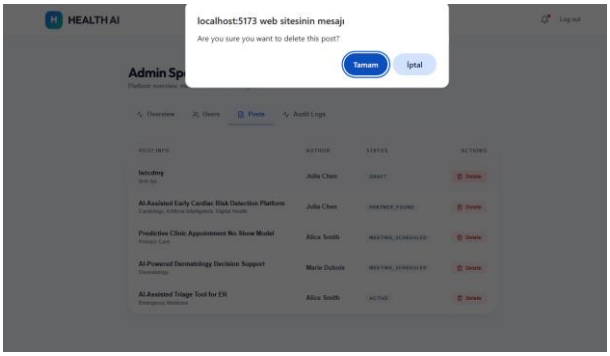
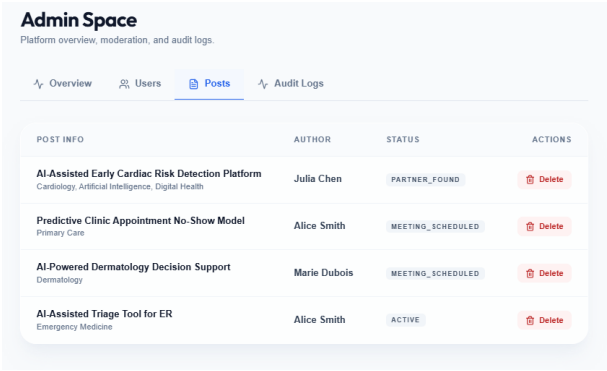
7. Admin Panel

This section is only available to users with the Admin role.

7.1 Post Management

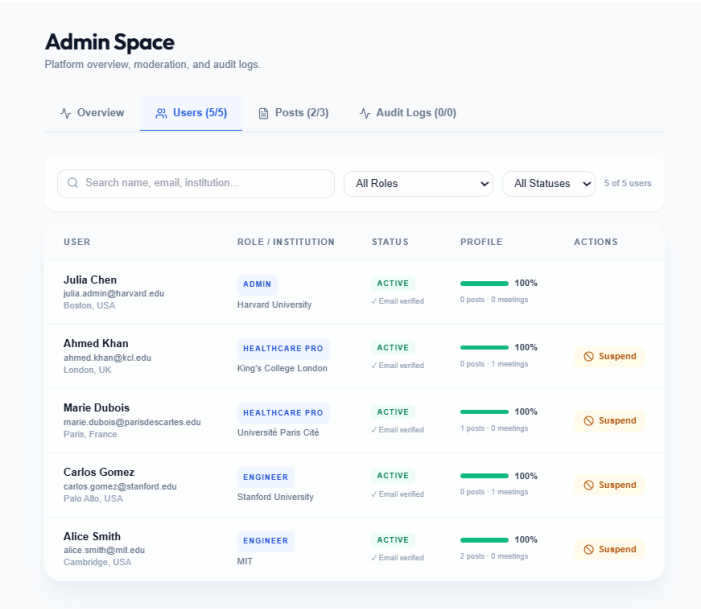
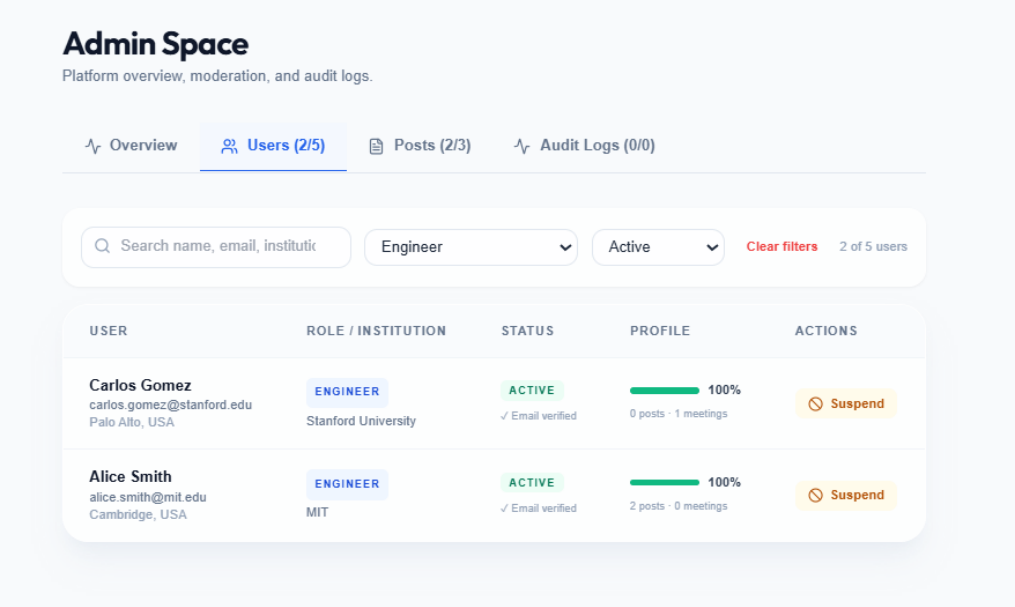
Admins can access all posts on the platform regardless of status. Navigate to the Admin Panel and select the "Posts" tab. Posts are listed in reverse-chronological order and include the owner's name, email, role, and the current post status. Use the filters to narrow by domain, status, or date. A post should be removed if it contains misleading information, violates platform guidelines, promotes commercial services unrelated to healthcare-engineering collaboration, or contains inappropriate content. Removing a post is a permanent action and cannot be undone.

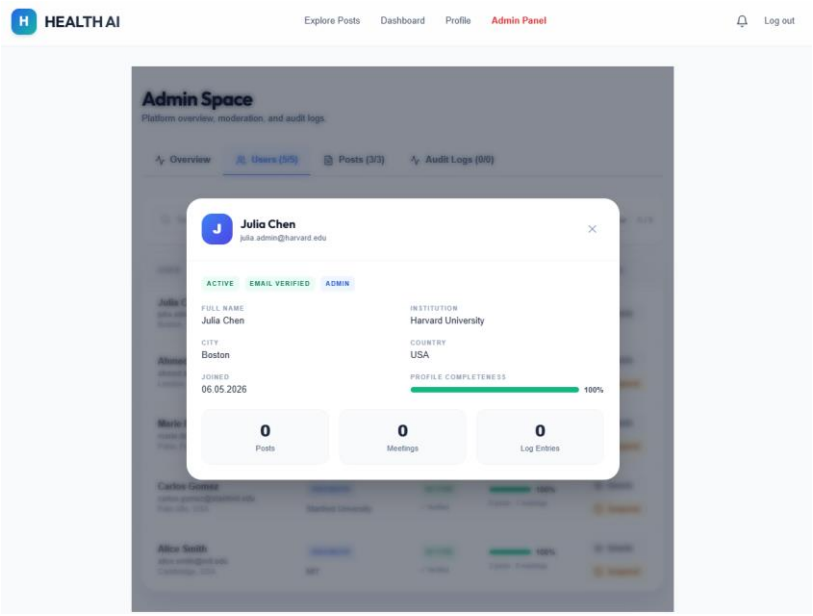
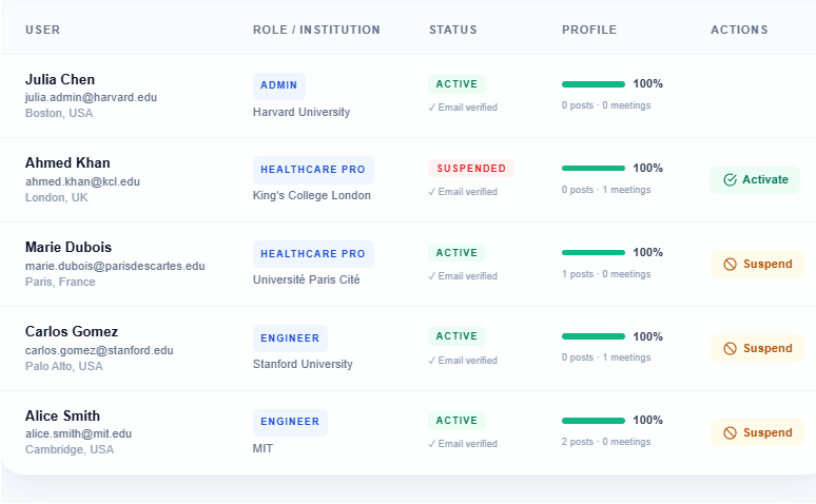
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to Admin Panel → Posts.	
2	Use the filter bar: type in the search box to match title, author, or domain; select a Status from the dropdown; pick a Domain from the dynamic list; set a Published From/To date range. The post count in the tab label updates in real time (e.g., "Posts (3/12)").	

3	Click on a post to view details.	
4	Use the “Remove Post” button to remove inappropriate content.	  

7.2 User Management

Navigate to the Admin Panel and select the "Users" tab. The table lists all registered users with their full name, email, role, institution, city, country, email verification status, account status, profile completeness percentage, and counts of posts, meeting requests, and activity log entries. Use the role filter to display only Engineers, Healthcare Professionals, or Admins. Click "Suspend Account" to disable a user's access immediately; their account remains in the database but they cannot log in. Use "Activate Account" to restore access. Suspended users receive a "Your account has been suspended" message on login.

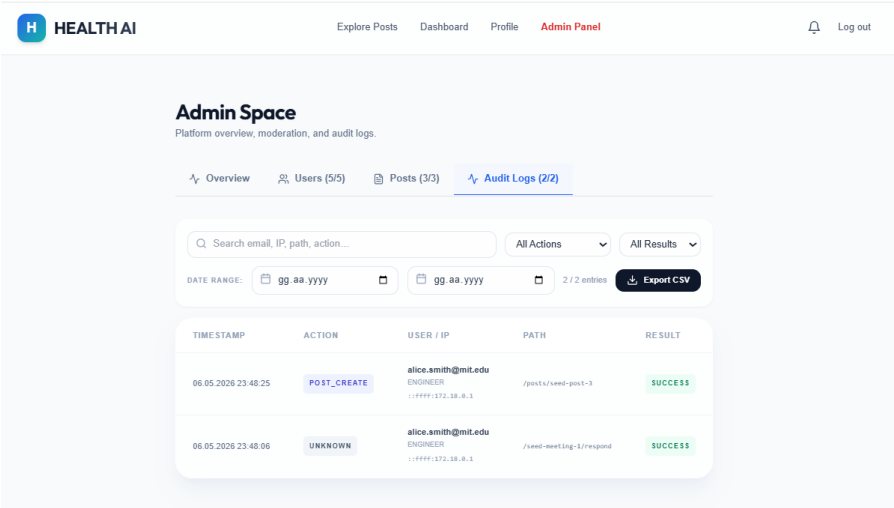
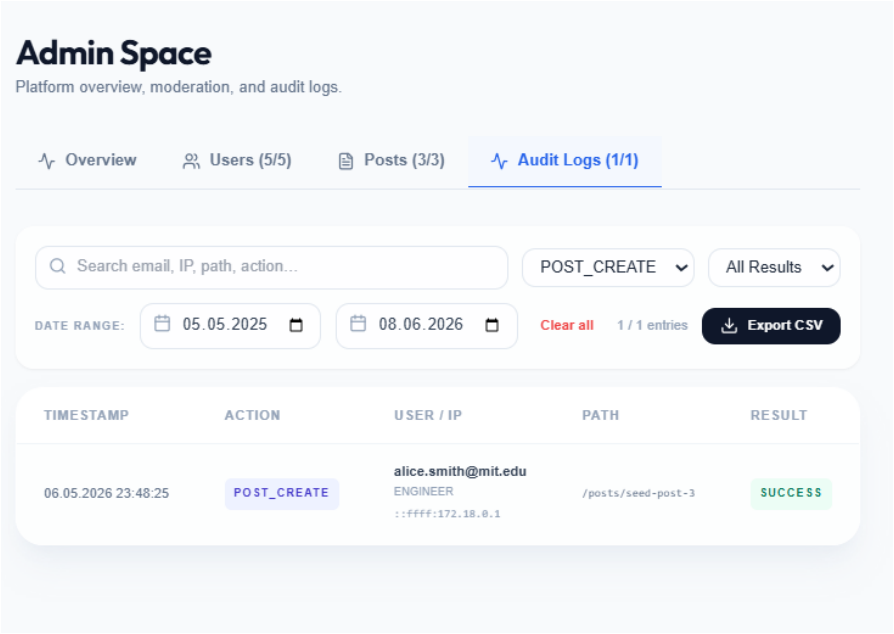
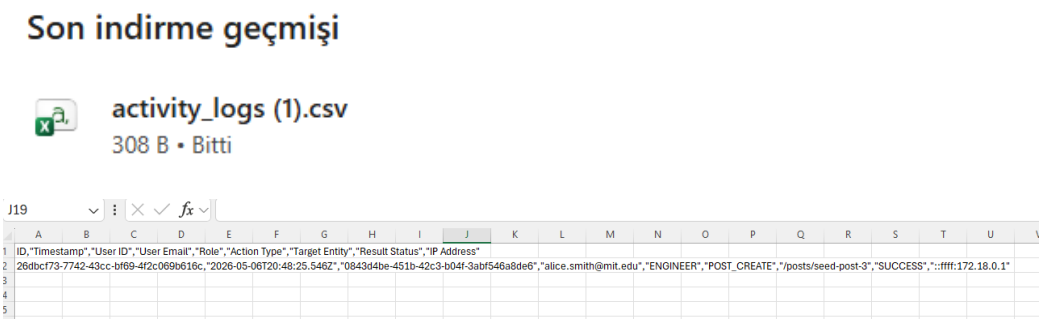
Step	Description	Screenshot
1	Navigate to Admin Panel → Users.	
2	Use the filter bar: type in the search box to match name, email, or institution; select a Role (Engineer / Healthcare Professional / Admin) or Status (Active / Suspended) from the dropdowns; set a Registered From/To date range. Results update instantly.	

3	Click on a user to view their profile and activity.	
4	Use “Suspend Account” if needed.	

7.3 Activity Logs & Statistics

Navigate to the Admin Panel and select the “Logs” tab. The log table shows up to the most recent 100 entries, each recording: timestamp, user ID, user email, role, action type (e.g., LOGIN, FAILED_LOGIN, POST_CREATE, POST_EDIT, POST_STATUS_CHANGE, POST_DELETE, MEETING_REQUEST, MEETING_RESPOND, ADMIN_ACTION), the target entity (URL path), result status (SUCCESS or FAILED), and the requester’s IP address. Use the filters to narrow by date, user ID, or action type. Click “Export CSV” to download the currently filtered log set as activity_logs.csv, which can be opened in any spreadsheet application for further analysis.

Step	Description	Screenshot

1	Navigate to Admin Panel → Logs.	
2	Use the filter bar: type in the search box to match email, IP, or path; select an Action Type from the dynamic dropdown; filter by Result (SUCCESS / FAILED); and set a Date Range (From / To). All filters combine in real time. Click “Clear all” to reset.	
3	Review the log entries in the table.	
4	Click “Export CSV” to download the filtered logs.	

8. Notifications

The platform delivers in-app notifications visible via the bell icon in the navigation bar. Notifications are fetched in real time and the unread count is shown as a badge. The table below lists all current notification types.

Notification Type	Description	Channel
Meeting Request Received	A new meeting request has been submitted for one of your posts	In-App
Meeting Request	A meeting request has been sent or received	In-App
Meeting Confirmed	A meeting request was accepted. Both the post owner and the requester receive a notification with the confirmed date and time, and a reminder to arrange the external meeting link (Zoom/Teams).	In-App
Post Status Changed	A post you're involved with changed status	In-App
Account Activity	System confirmations: account registered, post created, meeting request sent.	In-App
System / Other	System confirmations: post created, meeting request sent, meeting declined, or new time proposed by the other party.	In-App

9. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Question	Answer
My .edu email is not accepted. What should I do?	Ensure you are using an institutional email with a .edu or .edu.tr extension. If the issue persists, contact support.
I didn't receive the verification email.	Check your spam/junk folder. On the login page enter your email and password; if your email is not yet verified, a banner appears with a "Resend verification email" button — click it to receive a new link. The same button also appears on the Register success screen. If emails still do not arrive, the platform administrator may need to configure the server's SMTP settings.
Can I edit a published post?	Yes, you can edit your post at any time while it is in Draft or Active status.
How do I delete my account and data?	Go to Profile Settings → Delete Account. This action is permanent and cannot be undone.
Are meetings held on the platform?	No. Meetings are conducted on external platforms (Zoom, Teams, etc.). The platform only facilitates scheduling.
Can I have multiple active posts?	Yes, you can have multiple Active posts at the same time. There is no enforced limit on concurrent posts, but we encourage keeping posts up to date so other users can trust that opportunities are still open.
What should I do if I can't log in after registering?	If your email is verified but login still fails, your account may have been suspended. Contact the platform administrator at the support address listed in Section 11.

10. Troubleshooting

Problem	Possible Cause	Solution
Page is not loading	Internet connection issue or server downtime	Check your connection. Try refreshing the page. If the issue persists, try again later.
Session closed unexpectedly	Session timeout or browser cookie issue	Log in again. Enable cookies in your browser settings.
Filters return no results	No posts match the selected criteria	Try broader filter settings or remove some filters.
Cannot submit meeting request	Post may have been closed or you haven't accepted the NDA	Refresh the post page and check the NDA acceptance step.
Meeting request form shows "NDA must be accepted"	The NDA acceptance checkbox was not ticked.	Scroll down in the meeting request form, tick the "I accept the NDA terms" checkbox, then submit again.
Verification email not received	Email may be in spam, or the mail server may not be configured.	Check your spam/junk folder. On the login page click "Didn't receive it? Resend email". If still not received, contact the administrator — the server's SMTP settings may need to be configured.
Registration says "email already registered" but I cannot log in	Account exists but email verification was never completed.	Try logging in with your credentials. The login page will show an "Email not verified" banner with a "Resend verification email" button. Click it to receive a new verification link.

11. Contact & Support

Channel	Details
Email	support@healthai.edu.tr
In-Platform Feedback	Use the "Feedback" button in the footer to submit suggestions or report issues.
Platform Documentation	Visit the README and docs folder in the project repository for technical documentation including SRS and SDD.

12. Appendices

Appendix A: Post Status Lifecycle

Every collaboration post passes through the following status states. Transitions are enforced server-side and cannot be skipped.

Status	Description	Who triggers
DRAFT	Saved but hidden from other users.	Post owner (on create or publish toggle)

ACTIVE	Visible to all users; meeting requests accepted.	Post owner (publish)
MEETING_SCHEDULED	A meeting request was accepted. Both parties are notified with the confirmed date and time.	System (auto on meeting accept)
PARTNER_FOUND	Collaboration partner identified; post closed to new requests.	Post owner ("Mark as Partner Found")
EXPIRED	Post passed its expiry date or was manually expired.	Post owner or system

Appendix B: Meeting Request Workflow

The meeting request lifecycle has three statuses: PENDING, ACCEPTED, and REJECTED. The table below shows the full flow including notifications sent at each step.

Step	Actor	Notification sent
1. Browse post → click "Request a Meeting"	Requester	—
2. Accept NDA, enter proposed time, submit	Requester	Post owner: "New meeting request for: [title]". Requester: "Meeting request sent for: [title]".
3a. Post owner accepts	Post owner (Dashboard → Incoming Requests)	Both parties receive a notification with the confirmed date and time. Post status → MEETING_SCHEDULED.
3b. Post owner proposes a new time	Post owner	Requester: "The post owner proposed a new time: [date/time]. Check your dashboard."
3c. Post owner rejects	Post owner	Requester: "Your meeting request for [title] was declined."
4. External meeting (Zoom / Teams)	Both parties (outside the platform)	—
5. Post owner marks "Partner Found"	Post owner	Post status → PARTNER_FOUND; no new requests accepted.

Appendix C: API Endpoint Quick Reference

All protected endpoints require a Bearer JWT token in the Authorization header.

Method	Endpoint	Auth	Description
POST	/auth/register	—	Register (.edu email required)
POST	/auth/login	—	Login; returns JWT access token (10h expiry)
POST	/auth/verify	—	Verify email with token from link
POST	/auth/resend-verification	—	Resend verification email
GET	/posts	—	List/filter posts (domain, city, expertise, country, stage, status)
POST	/posts	✓	Create a post (DRAFT or ACTIVE)
PUT	/posts/:id	✓	Edit post fields
PATCH	/posts/:id/status	✓	Change post status (e.g., PARTNER_FOUND)
POST	/meetings/posts/:postId	✓	Submit meeting request (NDA required)
PATCH	/meetings/:id/respond	✓	Accept / Reject / Propose new time
GET	/profile/export	✓	GDPR data export as my_data.json
DELETE	/profile	✓	Delete account permanently (GDPR)
GET	/logs/export	ADMIN	Download activity logs as CSV